



Black Bottom Cranberry Tart

FOR THE TART CRUST

1¾ cups (210g) all-purpose flour, plus more for rolling
¾ cup (90g) powdered sugar
¼ teaspoon kosher salt
6 tablespoons (85g) unsalted butter, cubed
3 large egg yolks, lightly beaten
1 teaspoon vanilla extract

FOR THE FILLING

¼ cup (60ml) heavy whipping cream
4 ounces (113g) dark chocolate, chopped bars or baking chips
¼ teaspoon ground allspice
2 cups (210g) fresh or thawed frozen cranberries
1¼ cups (250g) granulated sugar
Zest and juice of 1 orange
2 large eggs
2 large egg yolks
½ cup (1 stick/113g) cold unsalted butter, cubed

FOR THE SUGARED CRANBERRIES

¾ cup (150g) granulated sugar, plus more for coating
½ cup (52g) fresh or frozen cranberries

Most people's only introduction to cranberries is from a can or a juice carton, but the juice from the fruit itself—when not watered down or loaded with sugar—is intensely concentrated and tart. So if you're going to pair something with it, it needs to be a *flavor*—much like the bold dark chocolate in this tart. The combination screams holiday but in a deliciously unexpected way. And if you have any cranberry juice left over—the good stuff—I highly recommend it splashed over soda water for a refreshing palate cleanser between slices of this tart.

MAKES 1 (9-INCH) TART

MAKE THE TART CRUST: Preheat the oven to 350°F.

In the bowl of a food processor, add the flour, sugar, and salt and pulse to combine. Add the butter and pulse until very crumbled. Add the egg yolks and vanilla and pulse until a dough ball starts to form.

Turn the dough out onto a lightly floured surface and knead a few times until it comes together. Shape the dough into a disk and roll it between two pieces of parchment paper into an 11-inch (⅛-inch-thick) circle. Remove the top piece of parchment. Flip the dough into a 9-inch fluted tart pan with a removable bottom and peel off the remaining piece of parchment. Press the dough into the bottom and sides of the tart pan. Trim the excess dough by running a sharp knife along the top edge of the pan. Place the pan on a rimmed baking sheet and pierce the bottom of the dough all over with a fork. Line the pan with parchment paper and fill it with pie weights or dried beans.

Bake for 20 minutes and carefully remove the parchment and weights. Continue baking until golden brown and dry in appearance, about 8 more minutes. Let the tart crust cool completely.

MAKE THE FILLING: In a small saucepan over medium heat, heat the cream until it is very steamy, about 3 minutes. Remove the pan from the heat and add the chocolate and allspice, stirring until the chocolate is completely melted and smooth. Pour the ganache into the tart shell and spread it to evenly cover the bottom. Chill until firm to the touch, about 30 minutes.

continued

Set a fine mesh sieve over a large bowl and set aside.

In a large saucepan over medium heat, combine the cranberries, sugar, and orange zest and juice. Cook, stirring occasionally, until the berries burst and have softened, about 12 minutes. Pour the mixture into the sieve and press on the solids with the back of a spoon. Discard any remaining solids.

Return the strained cranberry mixture to the saucepan and whisk in the eggs and egg yolks. Cook over medium heat, whisking gently and constantly, until the mixture is thickened and the whisk leaves a trail as it goes through, about 5 minutes. Remove the pan from the heat and whisk in the cold butter until fully combined. Pour the cranberry curd into the chilled tart shell. Gently tap the pan on the counter to level the curd and remove any air bubbles. Chill for at least 4 hours or overnight.

MAKE THE SUGARED CRANBERRIES: In a small saucepan over medium heat, whisk the sugar with $\frac{1}{2}$ cup of water and bring to a simmer. Turn off the heat and add the cranberries. Let stand, stirring occasionally, for 1 hour. Remove the cranberries and toss in more granulated sugar to coat. Spread the coated cranberries on a parchment paper-lined baking sheet and let sit for a few minutes to dry.

To serve, place the tart pan on top of an elevated flat container (like a large coffee can or soup bowl). Gently press the outer rim of the tart pan down until it slips off the crust. Set the tart, still on the bottom of the pan, on a plate or platter. Slip the blade of a large offset spatula or long thin knife between the bottom of the crust and the bottom of the tart pan. Run the blade all the way around the tart to release it and carefully remove the tart pan bottom. Top the tart with the sugared cranberries when you're ready to serve.

TIPS & TRICKS

The sugared cranberries are best if made the day you are planning to decorate and serve the tart. After about 24 hours, the sugar will absorb moisture and they can start to turn sticky and not look crystallized. They'll still taste delicious!